

Printable classroom and home pack

PhonoBuddy Reception Phonics Starter Pack

Short, practical worksheets for daily sound recognition, blending, tricky words, and parent-led practice.

s	a	t	p	i	n
m	d	g	o	c	k
ck	e	u	r	h	b

Includes: sound cards, blending ladders, word tracing, tricky word practice, and a 14-day routine.

Original PhonoBuddy resource. Designed for adult-supported Reception phonics practice.

How to use this pack

Use one short page at a time. Five calm minutes is better than a long session that becomes hard work.

1. Say the sound

Point to one card. Say the pure sound, then ask the child to repeat it.

2. Find it

Ask the child to find the same grapheme in a word ladder or sentence.

3. Blend it

Touch each sound from left to right, then sweep across and read the word.

4. Keep it light

Stop while it is still going well. Put a tick in the tracker and come back tomorrow.

14-day practice tracker

Day	Sound	Words	Tricky word	Adult note
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				

Tip: If a word is hard, return to the sound cards. Confidence comes from small repetitions.

Phase 2 sound cards

s sss like a snake hissing	a ah like biting an apple	t t a quick tap sound, NOT 'tuh'	p p a tiny puff of air, NOT 'puh'
i ih short sharp sound like 'itch'	n nnn hum through your nose	m mmm lips together, hum	d d quick tap of tongue behind teeth, NOT 'duh'
g g gurgle in throat, NOT 'guh'	o o round mouth, short sound	c c click at back of throat, NOT 'cuh'	k k same as c, click at back of throat
ck ck click! Same sound as c and k	e e like the start of 'egg'	u u short sound like 'uh-oh'	r rrr like a growling puppy
h h a puff of hot air, like panting	b b lips pop open, NOT 'buh'	f fff teeth on lip, blow air	ff ff same as f but used at end of words
l lll tongue behind teeth, let sound flow	ll ll same as l but used at end of words	ss ss same as s but used at end of words	

Cut these cards out or leave the page whole for quick pointing practice.

Phase 3 sound cards 1

j j tongue jumps behind teeth, NOT 'juh'	v vvv teeth on lip, let it vibrate	w w round your lips, quick sound	x x two sounds together: k-s
y y tongue at roof of mouth, quick	z zzz like a buzzing bee	zz zz same buzz at the end of words	qu qu always together! k-w
ch ch like a train: ch, ch, ch	sh sh finger on lips, be quiet!	th th tongue between teeth, blow air	ng ng sound at the back of your throat, like singing
ai ai long 'a' as in rain	ee ee long 'e' as in bee	igh igh say 'eye', the letters igh make the long 'i' sound	oa oa long 'o' as in boat
oo as in moon oo long sound as in moon	oo as in book oo short sound as in book	ar ar open wide like at the doctor: aaahr	or or like opening a creaky door
ur ur like shivering: burrr	ow ow like stubbing your toe: ow!	oi oi like a pirate's ahoy: oi!	ear ear like pointing to your ear

Cut these cards out or leave the page whole for quick pointing practice.

Phase 3 sound cards 2

air

air like feeling the breeze

ure

ure like sure, are you sure?

er

er the quiet sound at the end
of words like 'letter'

Cut these cards out or leave the page whole for quick pointing practice.

Phase 2 blending ladders

Touch each sound, then blend smoothly across the word.

WORD 1	WORD 2	WORD 3	WORD 4
sat s - a - t	tap t - a - p	pat p - a - t	sip s - i - p
sit s - i - t	pin p - i - n	tip t - i - p	nap n - a - p
man m - a - n	map m - a - p	dig d - i - g	dad d - a - d
pig p - i - g	dog d - o - g	got g - o - t	pot p - o - t
cat c - a - t	cap c - a - p	kid k - i - d	kit k - i - t
net n - e - t	pen p - e - n	pet p - e - t	cup c - u - p
sun s - u - n	run r - u - n	rug r - u - g	mug m - u - g
rat r - a - t	hat h - a - t	hot h - o - t	hit h - i - t
hug h - u - g	bat b - a - t	big b - i - g	bed b - e - d
bug b - u - g	bus b - u - s	fun f - u - n	fan f - a - n
lip l - i - p	log l - o - g	leg l - e - g	

Phase 3 blending ladders

Touch each sound, then blend smoothly across the word.

WORD 1	WORD 2	WORD 3	WORD 4
jam j - a - m	jet j - e - t	van v - a - n	vet v - e - t
win w - i - n	wag w - a - g	web w - e - b	box b - o - x
fix f - i - x	mix m - i - x	six s - i - x	yes y - e - s
yam y - a - m	zip z - i - p	buzz b - u - zz	fizz f - i - zz
quiz qu - i - z	chop ch - o - p	chin ch - i - n	chip ch - i - p
rich r - i - ch	ship sh - i - p	shop sh - o - p	shed sh - e - d
fish f - i - sh	cash c - a - sh	thin th - i - n	ring r - i - ng
song s - o - ng	king k - i - ng	long l - o - ng	rain r - ai - n
tail t - ai - l	wait w - ai - t	pain p - ai - n	train t - r - ai - n
see s - ee	feel f - ee - l	feet f - ee - t	keep k - ee - p
week w - ee - k	green g - r - ee - n	night n - igh - t	light l - igh - t
right r - igh - t	boat b - oa - t	coat c - oa - t	goat g - oa - t

Phase 4 word ladders

Touch each sound, then blend smoothly across the word.

WORD 1	WORD 2	WORD 3	WORD 4
went w-e-n-t	help h-e-l-p	just j-u-s-t	tent t-e-n-t
belt b-e-l-t	band b-a-n-d	nest n-e-s-t	best b-e-s-t
lost l-o-s-t	milk m-i-l-k	jump j-u-m-p	next n-e-x-t
hand h-a-n-d	fast f-a-s-t	lamp l-a-m-p	gift g-i-f-t
pond p-o-n-d	soft s-o-f-t	camp c-a-m-p	hump h-u-m-p
stop s-t-o-p	spot s-p-o-t	frog f-r-o-g	step s-t-e-p
plan p-l-a-n	trip t-r-i-p	grab g-r-a-b	spin s-p-i-n
flag f-l-a-g	glad g-l-a-d	twin t-w-i-n	plum p-l-u-m
swim s-w-i-m	clap c-l-a-p	drop d-r-o-p	from f-r-o-m
stand s-t-a-n-d	trust t-r-u-s-t	spend s-p-e-n-d	twist t-w-i-s-t
frost f-r-o-s-t	stamp s-t-a-m-p	blend b-l-e-n-d	trunk t-r-u-n-k

Phase 2 word writing

Read the word, say it in a sentence, then write it on the line.

sat

tap

pat

sip

sit

pin

tip

nap

man

map

dig

dad

pig

dog

Phase 3 word writing

Read the word, say it in a sentence, then write it on the line.

jam

jet

van

vet

win

wag

web

box

fix

mix

six

yes

yam

zip

Tricky word practice

Read the word. Cover it. Write it. Check it. Circle the part that does not behave as expected.

the

Tricky part: e

to

Tricky part: o

I

Tricky part: I

no

Tricky part: o

go

Tricky part: o

into

Tricky part: o

he

Tricky part: e

she

Tricky part: e

we

Tricky part: e

me

Tricky part: e

be

Tricky part: e

was

Tricky part: a

you

Tricky part: you

they

Tricky part: ey

all

Tricky part: a

are

Tricky part: are